TRANSCRIPT OF A SPEECH MADE BY THE PRIME MINISTER, MR. LEE KUAN YEW, OPENING THE AGRICULTURAL SHOW AT THE KALLANG PARK IN THE EVENING ON 19TH SEPTEMBER 1965.

I do not want to repeat what I have said just now in Malay; (it was) very simple and I expect, over the years, more and more people to understand simple Malay.

But I would like to say that there is a little bit of the flair for greatness when we call this an agricultural show. You know, for an island of 214 square miles at low tide, and at high tide perhaps, two square miles less, to talk of agriculture is to take of agriculture is to take a deep breath and spread one's chest out, and I think that is what Singapore has been doing.

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Fifteen years ago, we imported our pork; we imported our eggs and our chickens. You know, you do not require much space to breed chickens, and for chickens to lay eggs. You can have them one over the other in little cages. People have also discovered that (they) do not require much space to breed good pork, and we export them. And so, you will discover many other lines in which space is not the major factor.

I would say very often others insist on making us profit. During the Emergency, in the years 1948 to the early fifties, before that we used to import our chickens, eggs, pork, mutton from Johore; vegetables (also). Then the Emergency started and the farmers came down to Singapore. So they lost the skills; we acquired the skills. And they never caught up again. They haven't caught up, and I doubt whether in the special fields of animal husbandry they ever will. You see, it is such a vast area: 50,000 squares miles West Malaysia (and) 80,000 square miles East Malaysia. You will wander around for miles; you cannot find your chickens.

But in Singapore, we have got them all neatly stacked in little wire-mesh cages. You never lose your chickens. And the eggs; you can note down every day how many eggs are laid: not how many eggs in a year, but how many eggs per day.

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So, you see, it is the quality, the mettle of a people which decides its future; not the size of the territory, the girth, the numbers. They are important, you know, some times, provided other things are equal. One heavy-weight versus another heavy-weight ... other things equal .... well, it is going to be tough fight. One heavy-weight versus one light-weight? (Well) I think one heavy

weight still survives. I am not saying (that) Singapore is a heavy-weight: I am just saying we are welterweight: small, compact and determined to survive and let nobody doubt them. And let nobody doubt that we will go to the ends of the world to see that we do.

You know, some people like to put on knuckle-dusters and brandish it to the world. We never do that. We always bow deeply. You know our lion dancers, they prance, they jump around and they bow and we bow back. But if it came to it, the chap who can do the lion dancing can jump over barbed-wire and do a lot of other things besides.

And so I would ask friends and foes alike - and I hope we have more friends than foes in South East Asia - to take note that we intend to be part of Southeast Asia, to be here for the next thousand years. And whilst we may not be here, our progeny will. Our posterity will be here, and here we will remain striking deeper and deeper roots, and we (shall) never run away from a scrap.

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Finally, I want to congratulate the committee for having arranged this. This was swamp, you know, when I was little boy, going to the school in Siglap. It was swamp land (or) what they call marsh-land: sea water came up with the tides. Over the years, (through) human skill, labour, vision, it became an airport,

It is now Kallang Park. There is a big debate whether we have a National Stadium here or in Toa Payoh where the new town will be.

So we progress. Nothing will hold us back. Not even if they try to really smack us in the eye, because you know, we got pretty tough eyes apart from having tough necks which cannot be (squeezed) so easily. Even our chickens have got tough necks if you buy them.

But I want to congratulate the committee for one thing, I noted one point, It said, "The show is organized at no cost to the Government."

And it went on further to say .... say I give the gold medal to this, and he got a gold medal ... "30 cents for adults and 20 cents for children; likely to make a profit." And the money, I am told, will go to promote the welfare and interests of the farming communities in Singapore.

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Now I say that it is not only good economics; that is good political activity.

So on that note, my congratulations to one and all.